1.	*na uluqu*	‘my head’
2.	*na nona wau*	‘her weapon (she owns)’
3.	*na memunī bia*	‘your$_{\text{PL}}$ beer’
4.	*na kemudrau itukutuku*	‘your$_{\text{DU}}$ story (about you two)’
5.	*na nona motokaa*	‘her car’
6.	*na meda tī*	‘our$_{\text{INCL}}$ tea’
7.	*na kelemu*	‘your$_{\text{SG}}$ belly’
8.	*na nona dio*	‘her oyster (she’ll sell)’
9.	*na kequ uvi*	‘my yam’
10.	*na noqu itukutuku*	‘my story (I tell)’
11.	*na watiqu*	‘my spouse’
12.	*na kemunī vuaka*	‘your$_{\text{PL}}$ pig (you’ll eat)’
13.	*na nomu kato*	‘your$_{\text{SG}}$ basket’
14.	*na tamana*	‘her father’
15.	*na memudrau dio*	‘your$_{\text{DU}}$ oyster (you’ll slurp)’
16.	*na nodra vuaka*	‘their pig (they raise)’
17.	*na keda wau*	‘our$_{\text{INCL}}$ weapon (we’ll be hit with)’
18.	*na kedra raisi*	‘their rice’

Problem 5.6a Now the Fijian words are given to you. Your task is to translate the phrase in the table into Fijian:

	Fijian	English	English phrase to translate
19.	*uto*	‘heart’	‘my heart’
20.	*yaqona*	‘kava’	‘her kava (she’s drinking)’
21.	*yaqona*	‘kava’	‘her kava (drunk in her honour)’
22.	*draunikau*	‘witchcraft’	‘my witchcraft (used on/against me)’
23.	*draunikau*	‘witchcraft’	‘your$_{\text{DU}}$ witchcraft (you’re making)’
24.	*dali*	‘rope’	‘your$_{\text{SG}}$ rope (you own)’
25.	*dali*	‘rope’	‘your$_{\text{PL}}$ rope (restraining you)’
26.	*ika*	‘fish’	‘your$_{\text{DU}}$ fish’
27.	*wai*	‘water’	‘your$_{\text{PL}}$ water’
28.	*luve*	‘child’	‘her child’
29.	*waqa*	‘canoe’	‘our$_{\text{INCL}}$ canoe’
30.	*yapolo*	‘apple’	‘their apple (they’ll sell)’
31.	*maqo*	‘mango’	‘their mango (for drinking)’

Problem 5.6b Explain your translation 21. (Why did you translate it this way?)

Problem 5.6c The word for 'coconut' is *niu*. List all the ways to say 'my coconut' and explain what they could mean.



'Weapon' refers to a club-like tool. A 'yam' is an edible starchy root. 'Kava' is a ceremonial drink.

The subscripts SG, DU, PL refer to singular (one person), dual (two persons), and plural (more than two persons), respectively. The subscript INCL means inclusive ('our$_{\text{INCL}}$' = belonging to me, you, and them, in contrast with 'our$_{\text{EXCL}}$' = belonging to me and them, but not you).

Solution

The first step we need to take is to determine the structure of the Fijian phrases. We can easily notice that all examples start with the word *na* followed by either one or two words. Separating the structures that contain a single word (i.e., the Fijian words for 'my head', 'your$_{\text{SG}}$ belly', 'my husband', 'her father'), we notice that all of them represent inalienable possessions. We therefore expect them to have the possessor marked directly on the noun, as an affix.

Indeed, comparing the structures 'my head' = *na uluqu* and 'my husband' = *na watiqu*, we discover that they both share the suffix *-qu*, which we then can deduce to mean 1SG possession. Therefore, for the inalienable possession, the phrase structure is *na* Noun–Poss.

In order to determine the structure of the rest of the phrases, we compare examples that contain the same noun (for example, 8 and 15, both containing the noun which means 'oyster'). We notice that both of them have the last word in common (*dio*), so the last word represents the noun, the possessed. Moreover, comparing examples 9 and 10 (both containing the possessive 'my'), we notice that they have in common the suffix *-qu* attached to the second word. Consequently, we can deduce that the structure of the alienable possession in Fijian is *na X*–Poss Noun. From here, we can easily determine the possession suffixes (applying similar processes as in Problem 5.5 where we had to separate the number from the classifier). We obtain: